

Mukesh Adhikari, PhD, MPH, MPA

HEALTH ECONOMIST · HEALTH SERVICES RESEARCHER · POLICY ANALYST

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Health economist specializing in causal policy evaluation on national administrative health data. Twenty-five peer-reviewed publications, including in *JAMA Health Forum*, *JAMA Internal Medicine*, and *The Lancet Global Health*, spanning quasi-experimental policy analysis, program effectiveness and implementation evaluation, and large-scale secondary data analysis in the United States and South Asia. Available for scoped, fixed-fee analytic engagements, external evaluator roles, short-term consultancy contracts, and named consultant positions on proposals.

METHODS

CAUSAL INFERENCE Difference-in-differences with staggered adoption; event-study designs; synthetic control; instrumental variables; regression discontinuity; matching and weighting

PROGRAM EVALUATION Effectiveness and implementation evaluation; fidelity and feasibility; logic models and evaluation frameworks; measurement design for health systems trials

ECONOMIC EVALUATION Cost-effectiveness analysis; costing of service delivery and program implementation; cost outcomes estimated alongside effectiveness

ADDITIONAL Latent class analysis; survival and discrete-time hazard models; interrupted time series; spatial and geographic access analysis; complex-survey analysis

DATA & ENGINEERING

U.S. ADMINISTRATIVE & SURVEY Medicare cost reports (HCRIS); Medicare Physician & Other Practitioners PUF; NPPEs; state licensure files; HRSA Area Health Resources Files; Health Professional Shortage Area designations; Federally Qualified Health Center program data; Medical Expenditure Panel Survey (MEPS); ACS/PUMS

INTERNATIONAL Demographic and Health Surveys (DHS); Multiple Indicator Cluster Surveys (MICS); Service Provision Assessments

ENGINEERING Reproducible analysis pipelines in R and Stata (modular master/config architecture, raw → built → analysis); Python; interactive data visualization (Observable); ArcGIS and county-level mapping; DHIS-2; NVivo

SELECTED ANALYTIC WORK

Under review — quasi-experimental designs

1. Effects of establishing residency training sites in nonmetropolitan counties on the county-level primary care physician supply: A staggered difference-in-difference approach. Under review, 2026.
2. Effects of rural training during residency on rural practice among physicians: An Instrumental Variable Approach. Under review, 2026.

Peer-reviewed — program evaluation and methods

1. The power of peers: an effectiveness evaluation of a community-based group antenatal care model in rural Nepal. *Reproductive Health*, 2019.
2. Measuring fidelity, feasibility, and costs: an implementation evaluation of a community-based group antenatal care model in rural Nepal. *Reproductive Health*, 2020.
3. Practical issues in the measurement of child survival in health systems trials in rural Nepal. *BMJ Global Health*, 2016.
4. Effect of COVID-19 on maternal and neonatal services. *The Lancet Global Health*, 2020.

Peer-reviewed — administrative-data policy analysis

5. The evolving role of critical access hospitals in rural physician training. *JAMA Health Forum*, 2025.
6. Comparing Indian Health Service sites to rural physician teaching hospitals. *JAMA Internal Medicine*, 2025.

7. Patient satisfaction with the components of the National Health Insurance Program of Nepal. *BMC Health Services Research*, 2025.

Seven of twenty-five peer-reviewed publications. Full list at mukeshadhikari.com.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Investigator · Cecil G. Sheps Center for Health Services Research, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill January 2025 – Present

- Design and lead quantitative studies of the physician workforce using national administrative databases.
- Evaluate policies affecting graduate medical education programs and rural health.
- Disseminate findings and their policy implications to stakeholders and at national research conferences.
- More than 10 studies to date, drawing on Physician Masterfile data, the HRSA Area Health Resources Files, and Health Professional Shortage Area designations.

Graduate Research Assistant · Rural Residency Program Development and Teaching Health Center Planning and Development, UNC Chapel Hill 2022 – 2024

- Process evaluation of rural residency programs, including primary data collection from participating programs and dissemination to federal and practitioner audiences.

Senior Public Health Officer · Department of Health Services, Government of Nepal 2013 – 2019

- Analyzed national health service statistics covering more than 6,000 health facilities.
- Facilitated data-based planning workshops at the national, provincial, and local levels of government.
- Posted to the District Health Offices of Achham and Rasuwa — a remote far-western hill district and a Himalayan border district — with district-level supervisory responsibility (Best Supervisor Award, District Health Office Rasuwa, 2015).
- Co-led evaluation of a community-based group antenatal care model in rural Nepal, covering effectiveness, implementation fidelity, feasibility, and cost.
- Contributed to design and deployment of a public-sector electronic medical record and community health worker-driven integrated care system in rural Nepal.

Co-founder (volunteer) · Nepal Health Policy Lab, nepalhealthpolicy.org 2026 – Present

- Co-founded an independent policy lab that contextualizes global health research for Nepal's policymakers; outputs include evidence briefs, an evidence database, and the Nepal Health Policy Digest.

Deputy Executive Director (volunteer) · Health Foundation Nepal 2024 – Present

- Lead the organization's US chapter; guide overall organizational activities and direction.

Director of Research, Education, and New Initiatives (volunteer) · Health Foundation Nepal 2022 – 2024

- Identified and implemented research opportunities across HFN programs; managed its research and educational activities.

Earlier research assistantships · Kathmandu University School of Medical Sciences; Yale University 2020 – 2022

- National Health Insurance Program evaluation and food procurement policy (Kathmandu University); Medicaid managed care auto-assignment (Yale).

EDUCATION

PhD, Health Policy and Management (Health Economics) · University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill · 2026

MPH, Health Policy · Yale School of Public Health · 2021

MPA · Kastamandap School of Public Affairs Management, Purbanchal University, Kathmandu · 2019

LANGUAGES

English (fluent) · Nepali (native) · Hindi (professional)

Updated August 2026 · Consulting engagements are undertaken independently. Institutional affiliations are employment history only and imply no institutional endorsement or sponsorship.